MAPLE-GLAZED SALMON

serves 4

Salmon is a sacred food for Indigenous peoples in the Columbia Plateau, just as it is for people near the coast. While maple trees are not native in the region, big-leaf maple trees grow not too much farther west. Syrup from this Western maple is deep in flavor with molasses-like notes. If you can find it, use it in this glaze, which is enlivened with vinegar and sumac, but any maple syrup will work well.

- 1 skin-on wild salmon fillet (1½ pounds)
- ¼ cup maple syrup
- 2 teaspoons cider vinegar
- 2 teaspoons sunflower oil
- 1 teaspoon ground sumac
- ½ teaspoon onion powder
- Sea salt
- Simply Cooked Camas (optional; page 313), for serving

Preheat the oven to 375°F. Line a sheet pan with parchment paper or aluminum foil (see Note).

Place the salmon on the pan skin-side down. Feel for any remaining pin bones and use tweezers to extract them, as needed.

In a small bowl, whisk together the maple syrup, vinegar, oil, sumac, and onion powder. Use this glaze to brush the fish, then season well with salt.

Bake for 5 minutes, then brush again with the glaze. Continue baking for about 5 minutes longer, or until a thermometer inserted into the thickest part registers 145°F, depending on the thickness of the fillet. (If the fish was frozen previously, you can cook it slightly less if you prefer salmon cooked to medium.)

If you'd like a bit more caramelization, broil the fish on high heat for 1 to 3 minutes.

Let the fish rest for a few minutes, then cut into portions and serve, accompanied with cooked camas, if desired.

Note: *To line the pan, you can use parchment paper, but if you'd like a more richly browned salmon, line the pan with foil so that you can finish it under the broiler.*